

# **Presentation types and Strategies**

# Types of Presentations

**There are two basic types of presentations that you will likely be called upon to make during your educational career and beyond —**

- **informative presentations and**
- **persuasive presentations.**

# Informative Presentations

The purpose of informative presentations is to promote understanding of an idea or to convey information. They are often used **to provide people with information** about a concept or idea that is new.

A presentation on **“How to Make a Good Presentation?”** is an example of an informative presentation.

# Persuasive Presentations

**The goal of a persuasive presentation is to influence a change in the belief, attitude, or behavior of another person when that person has some degree of free choice.**

**A persuasive presentation not only informs the audience about a topic, issue or event but also tries to get them to take specific and appropriate actions.**

# Presentation Strategies

## 1: Analyze your audience

**The first step in preparing a presentation is to learn more about the audience to whom you will be speaking. It's a good idea to obtain some information on the backgrounds, values, and interests of your audience so that you understand what the audience might expect from your presentation.**

## **2: Select a topic**

**Next, if possible select a topic that is of interest to the audience and to you. It will be much easier to make a presentation that the audience finds relevant, and more enjoyable to research a topic that is of interest to you.**

**In case, if you are not free in choice of topic and you are given a topic for presentation, then make it interesting and enjoyable for your audience.**

### **3: Define the purpose of the presentation**

**Once you have selected or given a topic, write the purpose of the presentation in a single concise statement. The purpose needs to specify exactly what you want your audience to learn from your presentation.**

**Base the purpose and the level of the content on the amount of time you have for the presentation and the background knowledge of the audience. Use this statement to help keep you focused as you research and develop the presentation.**

## **4: Prepare the body of the presentation**

**Here you decide how much information you can present in the amount of time allowed. Also, use your knowledge about the audience to prepare a presentation with the right level of detail. You don't want to plan a presentation that is too basic or too advanced.**

**The body of the presentation is where you present your ideas. To present your ideas convincingly, you will need to illustrate and support them. Strategies to help you do this include the following:**

- Present data and facts**
- Read quotes from experts**
- Relate personal experiences**
- Provide vivid descriptions**



## 5: Prepare the introduction and conclusion

**After preparing the body of the presentation, decide how you will begin and end the talk.**

**Make sure the introduction captures the attention of your audience and the conclusion summarizes and restates your important points.**

**In other words,**

**"Tell them what you are going to tell them. "**



During the **opening** of your presentation, **it's important to attract the audience's attention and build their interest.**

Strategies that you can use include the following:

- Make the introduction relevant to the listeners' goals, values, and needs
- Ask questions to stimulate thinking
- Share a personal experience
- Begin with a joke or humorous story
- Project a cartoon or colorful visual
- Make a stimulating or inspirational statement
- Give a unique demonstration

During the **conclusion** of your presentation, **restate the main ideas you communicated.**

## **6: Rehearse making the presentation**

**Most people spend hours preparing a presentation but very little time rehearsing it.**

**When you practice your presentation, you can reduce the number of mistakes. You can also fine-tune your content in the time allotted.**

## 7. Be a Credible Speaker

**It is not enough just to make a statement, you need to back it up by providing factual information, quoting an expert, or speaking from experience.**

**The point is, it's not enough to state your ideas, you need to be able to explain why you have those ideas.**

- **Be accurate and exact with quotes, names, dates, and facts.**

## **8: Dress in a professional manner**

**If you want to be taken seriously, then dress accordingly.  
Being the worst dressed person in the room just won't do.  
You don't need to have the most expensive clothes or the  
most current wardrobe, but do look well groomed.**

**Like it or not, research has determined that people are  
influenced by the appearance of the speaker.**

## **9: Control Your Nervousness**

- **If you are well prepared you will be less nervous. Practice your oral presentation in advance and keep rehearsing it until you're satisfied.**
- **Prior to the presentation dedicate time to focus and clear your head of other thoughts. Run through the presentation in your head one final time and remind yourself of how well prepared you are.**
- **Greet the people with whom you'll be speaking. This helps you create a rapport with the audience**
- **Make eye contact with members of the audience before you begin your presentation. If you've already established a rapport with them by greeting them, this will reestablish in your mind that the audience wants you to succeed.**

## **10: Voice**

**Using your voice effectively can have a great impact on your delivery. The best speaking voice is conversational, natural, and enthusiastic.**

**Speak loudly enough to be heard by everyone in the room, but vary the volume of your voice to maintain interest and emphasize key points.**

# 11: Gestures

- **Maintain eye contact with the audience. Eye contact signals that you care about them. Also use eye contact to detect confusion or boredom so that you can then modify your approach.**
- **Use positive facial expressions such as smiles, expressive eyes, and looks of empathy and encouragement to communicate feelings and emotions.**
- **Stand naturally with your feet spread slightly apart and arms relaxed at your sides.**
- **Use quick and energetic movements of your hands and arms to add expression to your talk. Maintain the attention of the audience by making your movements unpredictable.**



## **12: Visual Aids**

**Visual aids can help you emphasize main ideas, illustrate a concept, or stimulate the interest of your listeners.**

**Examples of visual aids include posters, overheads, flip charts, photographs, computer-generated slides.**

## 13:Remember the 10-20-30 Rule

This is a tip from **Guy Kawasaki** of Apple. He suggests that slideshows should:

- Contain **no more than 10 slides**;
- Last **no more than 20 minutes**; and
- Use a font size of **no less than 30 point**.